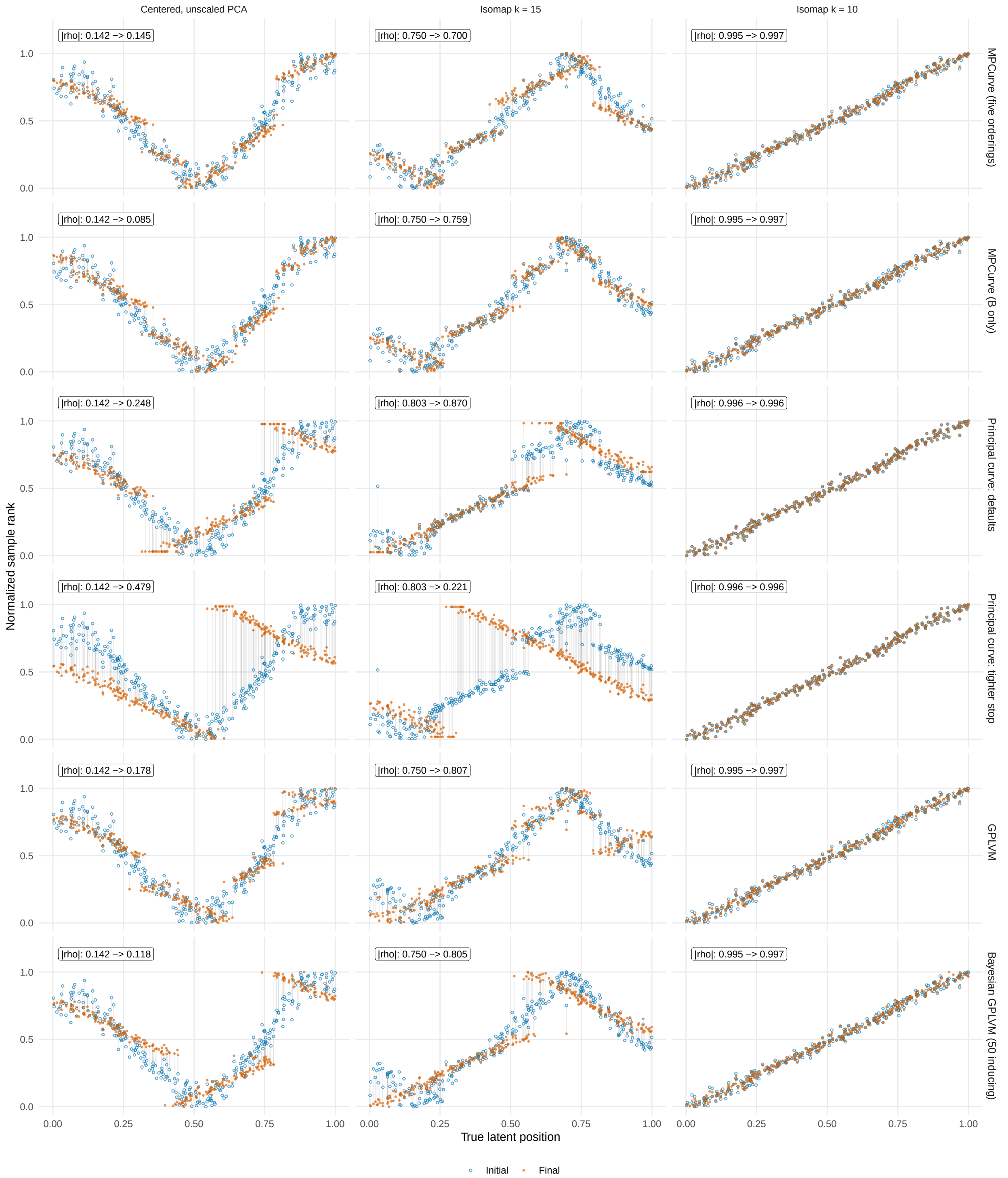


Original challenging case: initialization changes the comparison
 Same upstream starts; principal-curve Isomap starts additionally require a smooth curve and an initial projection.



Blue open circles: actual initial ranks; orange dots: final ranks. Gray lines connect the same sample.
 Absolute Spearman correlation removes global reversal. All single-order methods receive the same known 12 B features.
 MPCurve (five orderings) is the earlier full-data fit. Principal-curve tighter stop: maxit = 1000, thresh = 1e-6.
 Default principal curve: maxit = 10, thresh = 0.001. Its initial Isomap projection changes the raw ordering.